

ABUSE CASES IN TENNESSEE AND GEORGIA · SCRIPT A

Tennessee already proved misuse is real

About 2.1 min at ~140 words/min · 300 words · Replace [Your Name]. Speak calmly. One speaker, one focus.

Tip: swap bracketed fields. Cite numbers carefully. End with the cancel / yearly-vote ask.

Mayor Crawford, members of City Council. My name is [Your Name], and I live in Crossville.

Authoritarians say if you have done nothing wrong, you have nothing to hide. Tennessee's own record says officers can misuse these databases against real people.

In Oak Ridge, former officer Zachary Gauthier ran eighteen personal Flock searches, pleaded guilty to twenty-three official-misconduct counts, and was sentenced. That is not a rumor. It is a conviction covered by WBIR, WATE, WVLT, and 3B Media. Institute for Justice reporting separately describes a Shelby County ALPR misuse allegation involving more than a hundred plate lookups of an ex-wife. In Morristown, Business Insider's police-records reporting describes a Flock alert that helped trigger a gunpoint stop after a personalized plate was misread. Adults were handcuffed, and a child was left in the vehicle until the mismatch was sorted out.

Crossville has not published who can query local plate reads across the East Tennessee network. When agencies share data, misuse in one city can touch drivers scanned in another.

I am asking you not to shrug this off as "elsewhere." Oak Ridge is in our region. Morristown is in our region. Please do not tell residents that policy alone will fix this while refusing to publish who can search. A policy with no audits is just words on paper. Oak Ridge shows what happens when personal curiosity meets a powerful lookup tool.

THE ASK (say this)

My ask is clear. Cancel Crossville's Flock contract and remove the cameras. Require a public hearing and a recorded City Council vote before any surveillance equipment is ever proposed again. If you will not cancel yet, take a recorded yes-or-no vote each year before any renewal, with no automatic renewal that skips a public vote, and publish monthly use reports the public can check. Thank you. I yield.

FLK-2025-027

YEAR

2025

STATE

TN

AGENCY JURISDICTION

Oak Ridge Police Department

SUBJECT OFFICER INVOLVED

Officer Zachary D. Gauthier

SYSTEM VENDOR

Flock Safety

MISUSE ABUSE CATEGORY

Unauthorized Access / Personal Tracking

DOCUMENTED SEARCH COUNT FREQUENCY

18 (Flock-specific counts of 23 total)

DETAILED SUMMARY

Former Oak Ridge PD Officer Zachary Gauthier accessed the Flock ALPR system 18 times for personal (non-law-enforcement) use between February 25 and March 25, 2025, and also misused Accurint, the State Link System, and his patrol-car computer. An Anderson County Grand Jury indicted him on 23 counts of official misconduct (Class E felony) on July 1, 2025: 18 counts specifically for Flock misuse. He was placed on leave April 21, 2025, fired April 24, 2025, and pleaded guilty to all 23 counts on March 23, 2026 (48 hours custody, supervised probation, POST surrender, judicial diversion eligibility). Oak Ridge shares Flock data within the same East Tennessee network as Maryville.

DISCOVERY METHOD

Internal Oak Ridge PD complaints referred to Anderson County District Attorney General Dave Clark for independent investigation

OUTCOME DISCIPLINARY ACTION

Terminated April 24, 2025; indicted July 1, 2025 on 23 counts of official misconduct; pleaded guilty March 23, 2026; sentenced March 2026 to two years on each count with 48 hours to serve, remainder suspended probation, judicial diversion eligibility (3B Media / WATE).

REFERENCE SOURCE

WBIR 10News / WATE 6 News / WVLT / Maryville Residents for Privacy / Anderson County DA

SOURCE URL

<https://www.wbir.com/article/news/crime/da-former-oak-ridge-officer-pleads-guilty-23-counts-of-misconduct/51-c7b250d6-0843-4407-a0e2-2ecc68c2809a>

VERIFICATION STATUS

Verified

VERIFICATION NOTES

Documented on maryvilleprivacy.org (East TN regional Flock network context). Corroborated by WBIR indictment/plea coverage, WATE indictment detail (18 Flock counts), WVLT plea reporting (Mar 23, 2026), and Anderson County Grand Jury / DA Clark statements.

INCIDENT YEAR

2025

RESOLUTION YEAR

2026

YEAR NOTE

Year/Case_ID keyed to 2025 indictment/public charging; Incident_Year is Feb to Mar 2025 Flock queries; Resolution_Year is Mar 2026 guilty plea.

OUTCOME BUCKET

Terminated / Resigned & Criminally Charged

CrossvillePrivacy.org

Independent public-records research

CASE DATABASE

Flock Safety & ALPR Misuse Master Database

Verified officer-misuse / stalking incidents (54). Catalog generated_on=2026-08-07.

54 records	2026-08-07 exported	JSON source of truth
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How to read this dossier

Each card is one verified record from the matching JSON file on this site. Allegations are labeled as such. Prefer primary news and court links inside each record over secondary summaries. Excel and PDF are exports of the same data.

ALPR-2024-030

YEAR

2024

STATE

TN

AGENCY JURISDICTION

Shelby County Sheriff's Office

SUBJECT OFFICER INVOLVED

Deputy Thadius Gordon

SYSTEM VENDOR

ALPR (county database; Flock not confirmed in primary local coverage)

MISUSE ABUSE CATEGORY

Domestic Stalking

DOCUMENTED SEARCH COUNT FREQUENCY

100+

DETAILED SUMMARY

Deputy Gordon accessed county ALPR tracking databases more than 100 times to stalk his ex-wife and monitor her vehicular movements across the jurisdiction without law enforcement purpose.

DISCOVERY METHOD

Victim complaint and internal audit

OUTCOME DISCIPLINARY ACTION

Relieved of duty by Sheriff's Office; subjected to internal and criminal investigation.

REFERENCE SOURCE

Institute for Justice Nationwide ALPR Stalking Report

SOURCE URL

<https://ij.org/police-have-reportedly-used-license-plate-readers-to-stalk/>

VERIFICATION STATUS

Verified

VERIFICATION NOTES

IJ + local reporting: Shelby County Dep. Thadius Gordon; 100+ ALPR tracks of ex-wife; relieved of duty. Primary local coverage describes SCSO plate databases, do not assert Flock without a primary vendor source.

INCIDENT YEAR

2024

OUTCOME BUCKET

Relieved of Duty / Under Investigation